

Ava Hajratwala

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SUMMARY

Full-stack engineer and emerging leader passionate about creating software to make user, stakeholder, and developer experiences smoother. Experienced in full-stack development, AI research, and user-centered design. Seeking software engineering roles.

SKILLS

Languages: Java (SpringBoot), TypeScript, Python, C, C++, SQL (MSSQL, MySQL, PostgreSQL)

Frameworks: React, Spring, Angular, FastAPI, JUnit, Vitest, Playwright

Developer Tools: Azure, AWS, Docker, Kafka, Postman, CI/CD (GitHub & GitLab), Maven, Terraform

Libraries: Tailwind, jQuery, Bootstrap, NumPy

EXPERIENCE

Software Engineer

Jul. 2025 – Present

M&T Bank

Wilmington, DE

- Built custom ticketing workflows (Angular/Java Springboot) to reduce the bank's software licensing costs by \$400,000 annually.
- Supported migration of applications to the cloud (Azure), reducing operating costs and improving reliability.

Software Engineer

Sept. 2024 – Feb. 2025

WBAR Radio

New York, NY

- Automated frontend/backend deployment processes by building development environments and CI/CD pipelines, speeding up deployment times by 30x.
- Designed and deployed a scalable FastAPI backend, enabling access to up-to-date information on show schedules, archive recordings, and DJ profiles for over 1000 monthly users.
- Designed and implemented a database to allow users to publish their own site content.
- Implemented custom RBAC with SSO-enabled login to ensure data security for DJs and admin users.
- Coordinated interviews with 10 stakeholders across the organization, leading to UX improvements that boosted user satisfaction.

Undergraduate RL Research Lead

May 2024 – Dec. 2024

Soros Lab, Barnard College

New York, NY

- Developed genetic algorithms to investigate "reward-hacking" agents in a simulated lunar lander environment.
- Promoted to team lead in 3 months for strong leadership, organization, and communication skills.
- Cut approx. 10 hours per week of test runtime by parallelizing experiment trials (~7x speedup).
- Designed and implemented a testing GUI using Tkinter, which cut configuration time in half by eliminating source code updates.

EDUCATION

Barnard College, Columbia University

New York, NY

Bachelor of Arts in Computer Science

Sept. 2021 – Dec. 2024

Selected courses: Design for Generative AI, Parallel Functional Programming, NLP

GPA: 3.81/4.00

PROJECTS

Privacy Guardian | Python (Flask), React, OpenAI API, Vercel

Sept. 2024 – Feb. 2025

- Designed and built a full-stack React app to help users evaluate jargon-filled privacy policies using generative AI.
- Tested new features on 10 users while iterating on technical prototype, increasing user satisfaction by 30%.
- Increased user trust in the model's accuracy by implementing a feature that displayed citations alongside the model's claims.